



Grip health tracker

IBM has created a fingerprint sensor that can detect your grip strength and track your health through it. <https://digit.in/jan19-41>



Facebook suspends accounts

Facebook suspended five accounts for spreading false information during the 2017 Alabama special election. <https://digit.in/jan19-42>

Campfire Audio Atlas

Epic metallic excellence

A fine example of audiophile indulgence is the Campfire Audio Atlas. Packing some really impressive build quality, and a significant price tag, this stainless steel powerhouse will grab your attention for all the good reasons.

Design and Build

The Atlas boasts of stainless steel construction that is drop forged and then CNC machined and polished until it is shiny enough to reflect your face had it been small enough. There are the CA motifs on the side above the MMCX connectors. The overall housing is a bit larger as compared to the CA Comet but that is to house the large 10mm ADLC drivers it packs. The housings are bullet shaped and symmetric, so you can wear them in both cable-down and over-ear methods. We found the over ear method to be useful due to the weight of the stainless steel housings. The dome and the nozzle on the housings are designed so that the rest of the body can get out of the way and you're not left adjusting the earbuds eternally for a comfortable fit.

Interestingly, the driver housings on the Atlas are channel agnostic – it is the included MMCX connectors that are marked as the respective channels. The connectors are beryllium plated and quite durable. The Atlas comes with a 4-core pure Silver Litz cable that is covered in braided thin PVC coating, with the beryllium connectors on one side and a rubber right angle 3.5mm TRS gold-plated jack on the other. The wire itself is very tangle free. The Atlas comes with a carry case and a good selection of buds which lets you experiment with the fit.

Performance

Describing the Atlas as anything less than a behemoth would be an injustice. Campfire Audio has brought the Atlas to as close as it can get to the musical

definition of excitement. In terms of sound quality, the Atlas offers what can be described as 'Grand Sound' with its evident V-shaped signature. The sound staging is quite deep and spacious enough, and it allows the layering and the instrument separation in the sound to shine through.



The bass response on the Atlas is phenomenal. Tight and punchy, it holds its ground in all but the most bass heavy tracks and boosts the sub-bass by just the right amount, without being prone to generating any unnecessary booming. Overall, the bass performance on the Atlas is a joy to experience.

Keeping the energy and vividness at par with the lows, the mids also maintain a familiarity with the more neutral side of things. There's a lot of detail and accurate timbre to be discerned in your listening experience, especially if you're driving them from the right source. This, combined with the spacious nature of the sound from the Atlas, makes the listening experience very lifelike and natural. Along with the detail, the overall sound signature of the Atlas is full, pulling you into an unparalleled immersive experience like no other.

The highs on the Atlas retain the detail that you will find in the mids, without sounding stressed or rolled off. Never too bright or sharp, the

highs meld nicely with the other parts of the sound signature to contribute to the fullness of the Atlas' sound. Vocals in the mids sound very engaging in tracks where they're the main focus and take the back seat to the right extent where instruments are the primary focus.

Verdict

The Atlas is all about driving power – epic, spacious and vividly detailed power. Throughout our listening experience, the 10mm ADLC dynamic driver made its presence felt across the sound spectrum with equal authority. To us, this is the perfect flagship



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IEM to demonstrate how engaging music can be.

The Atlas shuns what is correct for what is epic, and does so with consistency, creating a listening experience that brings out the 'wow' factor in its performance. Those looking for a perfect balance might need to look elsewhere, and the same can be said for those looking for a pair of IEMs that offer a universal fit. The Atlas brings to you a grandeur that needs a particular audience, one that is more used to the liveliness of headphones and speakers. Pick this one up if you're looking for a pair of IEMs with energy, price no bar.

—Arnab Mukherjee

SPECIFICATIONS

FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 5Hz-20 kHz | SENSITIVITY: 105 dB SPL/mW | IMPEDANCE: 19 Ohms @ 1kHz | TOTAL HARMONIC DISTORTION: <1%

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